



Fiona Stanley Fremantle Hospitals Group

OFFICIAL

Procedure

Mental Health Police Co-Response Service

Reference #: FSFH-MENH-POL-0021

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
Fremantle Hospital	Mental Health Service	Medical, Nursing, Allied Health

1. Introduction

The Mental Health Police Co-Response service is a partnership between the Department of Health and Western Australian (WA) Police to provide a specialised crisis response service to police call outs identified as potentially involving a consumer with a suspected mental illness in need of mental health intervention. The Fremantle Hospital (FH) Mental Health Crisis Centre (MHCC) will roster senior mental health clinicians with the relevant skills knowledge and experience to accompany frontline WA Police Officers to complete joint mental health assessments in the FSFHG catchment area. This procedure clearly defines the service provided and the requirements for communication and documentation.

2. Terminology

Authorised Mental Health Practitioner (AMHP)	In accordance with the Mental Health Act 2014 the Chief Psychiatrist may designate a Mental Health Practitioner as an authorised Mental Health Practitioner if satisfied that the Practitioner has the qualifications, training and experience appropriate for performing the functions of an Authorised Mental Health Practitioner under this Act.
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3. Procedure

3.1. Service details

- The Mental Health Co-Response Service operates seven days a week between 12:00 – 22:00hrs and provides timely access to mental health assessment for consumers involved with police.
- Mental health clinicians working in the Police Co Response role may be from multiple disciplines within the MHCC team.

Clinicians working in the Police Co-Response role must be an AMHP.

- The Police Co Response clinician is positioned in the FH MHCC however is funded by the Mental Health Commission to be available and perform Co-Response duties.
- Co-Response provides face to face mental health assessments in a community setting where police have sought mental health input. It also provides advice to WA Police and MH Clinicians relating to FSFHG catchment patients.

3.2. Co-Response call out

- WA Police Operations Centre will request contact with the Co Response clinician via the Police Co Response mobile to advise of a request for a mental health assessment and provide relevant information.
- The Co Response clinician will:
 - access Psychiatric Services Online Information System (PSOLIS) and the digital medical record (DMR) to identify known and relevant information and risks to inform the response required.
 - if appropriate, the Co Response clinician will meet the police and consumer in the community and complete a face-to-face mental health assessment
 - facilitate direct access to Mental Health Services and supports as clinically indicated
- Where the WA Police catchment differs from the Co Response clinician catchment, it will be referred on to the relevant MHCC/ATT for assessment.
- The Co Response clinician may also provide liaison between WA Police and the health system.
- In the event a consumer's medical status is clinically prioritised above the mental health issue e.g., need for physical health or acute intoxication interventions the Co Response clinician in consultation with attending WA Police will determine the most appropriate course of action

- With consent from the consumer, their next of kin/carers will be informed of the event and actions taken in a timely manner.

3.3. Documentation

- The Co-Response clinician will complete a Mental Health Triage and Risk Assessment and Management Plan (RAMP) in webPSOLIS for each consumer under the “Cockburn Police Co Response” PSOLIS program when they have completed a mental health assessment.
- The Co Response clinician documents any assessments completed in the WA Police Co Response Contact Log, and advice offered and forward to MHCC for discussion at the next daily Multidisciplinary Team (MDT) Intake/Review Meeting.

3.4. Role of MHCC

- MHCC staff will review the Co-Response handover prior to the daily MDT Intake/Review Meeting and print relevant assessments/information from webPSOLIS, PSOLIS and medical record.
- The Co-Response assessment and handover is reviewed at the MHCC MDT Intake/Review meeting.
- When a consumer is already active with a community treatment team the information is forwarded to the relevant team.
- If the consumer is not active with a community mental health team, MHCC will review the requested outcome and consider a plan.
- Requested outcomes will include:
 - no further action/information only
 - contact consumer and offer appointment with MHCC
 - other onwards referral as appropriate e.g. if home address is outside the FSFHG catchment area.
- The MHCC Team Leader will escalate any disputed referrals or operational issues via the FH Program Manager, Adult.

4. Compliance/performance monitoring

- The MHCC Team Leader will be responsible for monitoring compliance with this document. Compliance will be monitored via routine clinical incident review processes and:
 - monitor Police Co-Response clinical incidents notified in the Datix Clinical Incident Management System.

- monitor Cockburn Police Co-Response KPIs monthly and report in MHCC monthly business meeting
- The Service Director will provide a six-monthly report to the Mental Health Commission which includes achievement of agreed key performance indicators.

5. Related policy documents

- WA Health:
 - [Safety Planning for Mental Health Consumers](#)
 - [Principles and best practice for the clinical care of people who may be suicidal](#)
 - [Principles and best practice for the clinical care of people who may be at risk of exhibiting violent or aggressive behaviour.](#)
 - [Statewide Standardised Clinical Documentation \(SSCD\) for Mental health Services](#)
- SMHS:
 - [Acute response mental health emergencies/crises \(SMHS: 17\)](#)
- FSFHG
 - Clinical Documentation (FSFH-HW-POL-0039)
 - Clinical care of people who may be suicidal (FSFH-HW-POL-0037)
 - Clinical Risk Assessment and Management (FSFH-HW-POL-0017)

6. Related legislation

- [The Mental Health Act 2014](#)

7. Related standards

- NSQHS Standards:
 - Clinical Governance
 - Comprehensive Care
 - Communicating for safety
 - Recognising and responding to acute deterioration
- The Chief Psychiatrists Standards for Clinical Care:

- Assessment
- Risk Assessment

8. Authorisation

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR: Service Director, Service 5					
Version	Date Issued	Compiled/Revised By	Committee/Consumer Group Consulted	Endorsed By	Revision due
1	10/2020	ATT Team Leader	Committee	FSFHG Policy Committee	10/2023
1.2	11/2023	ATT Team Leader		Service 5 SQR Committee	12/2026
2.0	07/2025	SMHS Policy Coordinator	Minor Update, no change to review date	Service 5 SQR Committee	12/2026